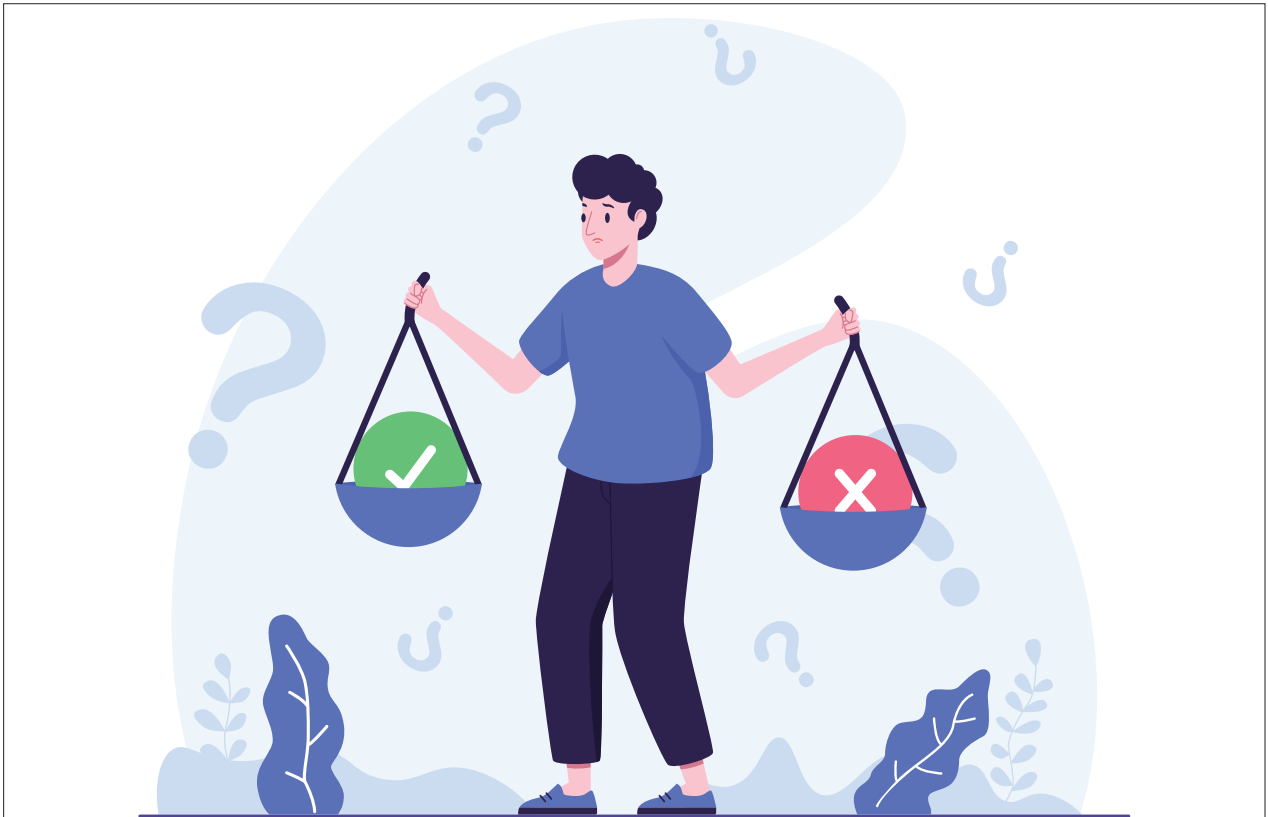




Stay legal, ethical and safe

Protect your show, your guests and every listener

A podcast can begin as two people talking into microphones and end as a permanent public record heard by thousands. That change of scale matters. The moment you publish another person's voice, play somebody else's music, repeat an allegation, collect listener information or accept money from a sponsor, legal and ethical questions enter the production workflow.

This chapter is a practical risk-reduction guide for Indian podcasters, not a substitute for advice from a qualified lawyer. Laws also change. The safest habit is therefore not memorising legal jargon, but building permissions, verification and documentation into every episode before publication.

Get permission before you press record

A guest agreeing to join a call does not automatically settle every question about how their voice, image, name and performance may later be edited, clipped, advertised or monetised. India's Copyright Act separately recognises rights connected with performances, including rights relating to sound and visual recordings and communication to the public. Written agreements are therefore far safer than relying on assumptions.

For regular interview shows, create a simple guest release. It should state the name of the show and producer; confirm that the guest agrees to audio and, where relevant, video recording; explain that the recording may be edited; permit publication,